

Companies to do for last backtesting methods:

- Shopify
- Sony
- Costco
- Nestlé

→ **Shopify**

Q1 - 26

- increase in R & gross profit
- more cash at end of period
- 34% revenue growth and 15% free cash flow margins
- very positive outlook for q2
- AI-driven store traGc grew 8x and orders from AI-powered searches increased nearly 13x
- great AI integration
- great tone; very confident

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.5. Time taken: 50 minutes

Q4 - 25

- numbers look GREAT (revenue; net income from operations; EPS diluted..)
- but free cash flow margin is down YoY
- Shopify Payments expanded to 60 new countries
- expect Q1 revenue growth in the low 30s year-over-year similar to our Q4 2025 growth rate
- agentic plan, lots of questions but confident responses

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.5. Time taken: 43 minutes

Q3 - 25

- numbers are good same as 2 previous quarters
- but gross profit is down YoY (48.9%, down from 51.7% a year ago)
- PayPal partnership expansion and lower noncash high-margin revenue
- Secured new large clients: Estee Lauder, e.l.f. Cosmetics, TWINSET, Welch's, Formlabs, FanDuel, Ladurée, and Stokke
- outlook for growth of 20% which is lower than two other quarters analysed
- "expanded partnership with PayPal, which will become less of a headwind in Q4 and beyond as we will have now lapped the initial expansion of the partnership, and lower noncash revenues from certain partnerships, which carry a high gross margin."

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.4. Time taken: 45 minutes

→ Sony

Q2 - 25

- sales are up; in every segment
- some tariff impact
- forecast of sales negative (-0.3%)
- total assets down
- tone is positive ish
- marathon to launch
- possible supply chain risk

Decision: HOLD; sentiment 0.1. Time taken: 37 minutes

Q3 - 25

- numbers look good except by segment some r not so great
- industry concerns
- partnership announced with TCL
- confident for the rest

Decision: HOLD; sentiment 0.2. Time taken: 30 minutes

Q1 - 26

- revenue is up 8% YoY
- operating income up and net income and operating margin improved from 13 to 16%
- earthquake impacted kumamoto semiconductor facility but production expected to resume by mid august
- mngt does not expect disruption to affect full year guidance

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.3. Time taken: 44 minutes

→ Costco

Q1 - 26

- numbers look amazing with sales up 8%; net income and EPS grew 13.6%; total paid members grew 5%
- gross margin 11%
- US and Canada renewal rates declined by 10 basis points due to lower renewal among new digitally- signed members.
- Inflation remains mixed across categories, while tariffs continue to require supply chain adjustments

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.4. Time taken: 40 minutes

Q2 - 26

- net sales and net income increased
- Costco opened 4 new warehouses
- Management reaffirmed plans to open 28 net new warehouses in FY2026
- US/Canada renewal slipped slightly due to faster growth in online memberships
- Potential instability in the Middle East could increase fuel costs and disrupt shipping schedules
- uncertainty around sourcing costs and pricing

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.3. Time taken: 46 minutes

Q3 - 26

- sales increased
- diluted EPS increasing to \$4.93
- Membership fee income rose 10.7% to \$1.37bn
- Site and app traffic increased 37%
- Gross margin declined due to lower pricing on everyday products and higher transportation costs linked to rising fuel prices
- Membership growth slowed to a more normal pace as Costco did not enter major new international markets during the quarter, although management remains confident in long-term membership growth

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.5. Time taken: 50 minutes

→ Nestle

Q1 - 2026

- Organic growth was 3.5%
- reported sales declined 5.7% due to adverse foreign exchange movements and the global infant formula recall
- Revenue reached a record \$404.6 million (+33.5% YoY)
- full-year margin outlook of 21–21.5%
- geopolitical disruptions, including higher freight and logistics costs, working capital pressure, and rising diesel prices, but mgt believes the diversified supply chain has limited operational disruption

Decision: BUY; sentiment 0.3. Time taken: 40 minutes

Q3 - 2024

- 2.0% organic growth
- Coffee remained the largest growth contributor
- e-commerce sales increased 9.7%

- pricing normalized after two years of exceptional inflation
- mgt lowered full-year expectations to around 2% organic growth and around 17% operating margin
- acknowledged that market share performance was not yet satisfactory

Decision: HOLD, sentiment 0.2. Time taken: 38 minutes